

society&the arts FASHION

MALE ORDER

Menswear made more than a passing impression even as the curtains fell on a lukewarm edition of Lakme Fashion Week

■ By Kimi Dangor and Jhilmil Motihar

The autumn-winter edition of Mumbai's Lakme Fashion Week (LFW) could have turned out to be a head-turner, if not for the far-from scintillating style soup, then for the head accessories that designers crowned models with. While Neeta Lulla's bizarre *Jodhaa Akbar* inspired turbans took the lead in the outlandish sweepstakes, Priya Kataria Puri towed the line in her over-the-top 1920s flapper inspired *topis* and Abhishek Dutta draped T-shirts like head scarves. On the lighter side of the cover-up coterie, Sabyasachi Mukherjee sent out models with Frida Kahloesque pompoms and flowers woven into their buns.

Yet when it finally came to a head, LFW proved again to be lagging behind in the battle for style supremacy. To be honest, the trend statements were all there—pin tucks and pleats, silks and satins and metallic fabrics—but in the swarm of pedestrian prêt-à-porter pondering, the focus of the week went missing.

But for fashion watchers it was refreshing to see menswear mark its presence. While Wills Lifestyle India Fashion Week saw Rohit Bal, Manoviraj Khosla, Fightercock, Raghavendra Rathore and Priya Awasthy dabble in gentlemanly grooming, LFW also proved to be a good opportunity for designers to delve into the

JJ Valaya

Tapered trousers, Jodhpur pants and structured jackets formed the collection

Narendra Kumar

Sports meet rock in this line of well cut short jackets and slim fit pants